It's possibly a little counterintuitive that query string data will always be exposed via `$_GET` regardless of the request method. Think of it like this: `GET` requests only really have one option to pass data to the server (the query string). `POST` and `PUT` have another mechanism available: the request body. PHP has some helpful automagical convenience features for this too. Create the following `index.php`…

```
// index.php
var_dump($_SERVER['HTTP_CONTENT_TYPE']);
print PHP_EOL;
var_dump(file_get_contents('php://input'));
print PHP_EOL;
var_dump($_POST);
```

… and make the following curl request:

```
$ curl -X 'POST' -d 'human=anna&cat=jess' http://localhost:8080/index.php
string(33) "application/x-www-form-urlencoded"

string(19) "human=anna&cat=jess"

array(2) {
  ["human"]=>
  string(4) "anna"
  ["cat"]=>
  string(4) "jess"
}
```

There are a few things to pay attention to here. We've changed the request method to `POST`, and we're supplying string data via the `-d` option, which tells curl that we want the `'human=anna&cat=jess'` string to be transmitted to the server as the request body (so it'll be sent after the initial request line and subsequent request headers). You'll notice that the format is identical to the query strings we've been using previously.

The output above also shows the `Content-Type:` header, which curl has automatically set to `application/x-www-form-urlencoded`. `Content-Type:` is a very important header, and the values allowed are controlled by IANA and known as "media types" (and by their old name: "MIME types"). More details can be found at https://www.iana.org/assignments/media-types/media-types.xhtml. In our case, the `application/x-www-form-urlencoded` value of this header triggers some behavior on